PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Tuesday, March 4, 2025

Regular Meeting

Meeting Minutes

(Adopted 3/18/25)

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Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Regular Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center - Board Auditorium, 501 N. Dixon St, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Director Julia Brim-Edwards: Present, Director Michelle DePass: Present, Director Herman Greene: Present, Director Gary Hollands: Present, Director Christy Splitt: Present, Director Patte Sullivan: Absent, Director Edward Wang: Present. Student Representative JJ Kunsevi: Present

Call to Order / Opening

The meeting was called to order at 6:05 pm by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Resolution to Recognize Classified and Non-Represented Employee Appreciation Week March 4-7, 2025 (Resolution 7053)

Time 6:06 pm

Staff: Sharon Reese - Chief of Human Resources

Staff highlighted four classified and non-represented employees who have completed 40 years of service. It was noted that Torch Award Nominations are now open through spring break. Chair Wang presented Kara Bradshaw with a 10-year service lanyard and Board members provided appreciation for her and all classified and non-rep employees. Resolution 7053 was adopted by a voice vote.

Chair Wang shared an overview of board meeting types and noted a parliamentary procedure related to board member participation.

> Actions:
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> Director Splitt moved and Director DePass seconded the motion to adopt Resolution 7053, Resolution to Recognize Classified and Non-Represented Employee Appreciation Week March 4-7, 2025. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed (Yes:5, No:0, Absent:2 [Greene & Sullivan])
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> Directors Brim-Edwards: Yes, DePass: Yes, Greene: Absent, Hollands: Yes, Splitt: Yes, Sullivan: Absent, Wang: Yes; Student Rep Kunsevi: Yes (unofficial)

Board Update on the 2025 General Obligation Bond

Time: 6:19 pm

Chair Wang noted that a one-page update on the bond proposal in each attendee's chair and directed people to visit yespdxschools.com for more information. Director Splitt shared that she will be hosting Q&A meetings around the district.

Superintendent's Report

Time: 6:23 pm

Superintendent Armstrong provided her report, with topics including Women's History Month, Classified and Non-Represented Staff Appreciation Month, the Lifting Literacy Campaign, and the bond campaign. She noted that it's a tough time to celebrate our employees, when staffing is being cut, and encouraged people to advocate at the state level for better school funding.

Student Representative's Report

Time 6:29 pm

A video was shown highlighting what Career and Technical Education (CTE) students are doing in the classroom across the district. Student Representative Kunsevi highlighted the importance of CTE

programs. He reported that on March 3, 2025, students advocated in Salem for themselves and their peers, urging the governor and legislators to increase public school funding. He also raised student concerns about insufficient lunch time and announced the upcoming District Student Council's annual summit on March 7, 2025.

Student Comment

Time 6:35 pm

- Evan Juenemann – Listen to community feedback about potential cuts, expressing concerns that SPED programming and arts programs may be the first programs to be cut.

Public Comment

Time: 6:39 pm

- Dr. Effie Greathouse: PPS communication on air quality has improved, still needs improvement to educate the community and help people from getting sick.
- Scott Bailey: Not in support of the 2025 Bond.
- Aryn Frazier & Yusef Leary: PPS The Center for Black Student Excellence is an essential need, urging the Board to move on the project now.
- Shannon Fasold: Lincoln HS. Do not cut Career Coordinators.

2025-2026 Budget Development with the Community Budget Review Committee (CBRC)

Time: 7:09 pm

Staff: Dr. Renard Adams – Chief Accountability and Equity Officer; Michelle Morris – Chief Financial Officer; Nichole Watson – Senior Director of Family and Community Engagement

Community Budget Review Committee (CBRC) Members: Caitlin Bice, Minyana Bishop, Karanja Crews, Aaron Cronan, and Grace Groom

Participants introduced themselves. Staff provided an overview of the budget engagement process, including past engagement efforts, key survey findings, and the development of an FAQ to address community questions. Staff encouraged advocacy at the state level.

The Board and CBRC Members participated in a Notices & Wonderings activity, discussing key observations and questions about the budget process and findings. Observations included the prioritization of classroom staffing, the importance of school flexibility, and concerns about limited staff engagement opportunities. Questions included how survey feedback may influence decisions, the need for policy flexibility in staffing, alignment between budget cuts and Board goals, and ensuring community input is reflected in final decisions. There was also interest in reviewing district-funded programs to explore cost-saving alternatives instead of cutting classroom instruction.

Dr. Armstrong highlighted in-person meetings she held with school staff, noting that administrators expressed a need for flexibility in allocations by school. As a result, schools were given a staffing model with options for reductions to better reflect the needs at each school. If additional state funding becomes available, allocations will be adjusted based on feedback.

Comments from our Union Partners

Time: 8:06 pm

- Portland Association of Teachers (PAT): Alicia Chavez and Angela Bonilla. PAT President Bonilla provided comments. She expressed appreciation for Superintendent Armstrong’s engagement and optimism about potential increased funding for special education. She highlighted advocacy efforts, including participation in the March 4th Day of Action and calls for increased state funding. She emphasized the need for educational assistants in kindergarten classes with more than twenty students, increased access to counselors, and maintaining staff levels by utilizing

reserves. Additional advocacy priorities included revenue reform, changes to the state's kicker policy, and rent reform to support enrollment stability.

Update on the Center for Black Student Excellence

Time: 8:16 pm

Staff: Nichole Watson - Senior Director of Family and Community Engagement and Quinn Peoples - Program Manager

The Board received an update on the Center for Black Student Excellence, including recent developments, priorities, pilot programs, measurement tools, and next steps. Staff shared the vision for the center as a space to uplift and support students, with access available to all PPS students. Discussion included funding for non-physical spaces, partnerships with affinity groups and Black Student Unions, and alternative ways to measure student achievement beyond testing and grades. Board members requested additional information on long-term financial planning, program implementation within school communities, potential site locations, operational costs, and a specific timeline. There was also interest in increasing student engagement and identifying community partners, as well as discussing how the Board can support the initiative.

BREAK 8:51 pm - 8:56 pm

Consent Agenda: Resolutions 7054 through 7057, 7059 through 7067, 7069 and 7070 through 7072.

Time: 8:57 pm

It was noted that two contracts, one field trip, and the Resolution to Approve a Senior Chief Salary Schedule was pulled from the consent agenda for individual consideration. The field trip that was pulled for individual consideration was moved back into the consent agenda by a voice vote. There was no board discussion.

7054 through 7057, 7059 through 7066, 7069, and 7070 through 7072

Actions Taken

Director DePass moved and Director Splitt seconded a motion to adopt the consent as amended, including Resolutions 7054 through 7057, 7059 through 7066, 7069, and 7070 through 7072. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed.

Brim-Edwards: Yes, DePass: Yes, Greene: Yes, Hollands: Yes, Splitt: Yes, Sullivan: Absent, Wang: Yes, Student Representative Kunsevi: Yes (unofficial)

Subsidiary Motion:

Director Brim-Ewards moved and Director Splitt seconded the motion to move Resolution 7069 back into the consent agenda. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed. (Yes: 6, No: 0, Absent: 1)

Brim-Edwards: Yes, DePass: Yes, Greene: Yes, Hollands: Yes, Splitt: Yes, Sullivan: Absent, Wang: Yes, Student Representative Kunsevi: Yes (unofficial)

Expenditure Contracts (Resolution 7067 and Resolution 7068)

Staff: Dan Jung – Chief Operating Officer and Stormy Shanks – Senior Director, School Modernization

The Board discussed two contract approvals related to the Cleveland and Ida B Wells modernization projects. A motion to combine the two resolutions was approved by a voice vote. Discussion including how the contract approvals align with recently implemented cost-saving measures and the potential to amend the contract scope to further reduce costs. It was noted that the pre-construction services are covered by the 2020 bond. There was discussion on the contracting method, the setting of Guaranteed Maximum Price (GMP), and reducing cost overruns. Staff explained that pre-construction work would not

be wasted even if the 2025 bond does not pass. Questions were raised about project timelines, contracting approaches, and past project performance.

The question was called by Director DePass. An amendment was introduced requiring regular reporting on the modernization process, leading to debate about whether there was enough time to review the amendment or potentially bringing it back for consideration at a future meeting. Staff noted they could provide smaller, less robust updates throughout the process, and the Board agreed to late submission of meeting materials as long as they met legal posting requirements. A suggestion was made to postpone the amendment for discussion at the next work session. The amendment passed by a voice vote.

The call to question was appealed, resulting in a tie vote. Chair Wang allowed discussion to continue, using the Student Representative's yes vote as the tiebreaker. Staff committed to sending a follow-up email to answer final questions. The combined resolutions were adopted as amended.

Actions:

Director DePass moved and Director Splitt seconded the motion to adopt resolution 7067, as amended. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed. (Yes – 6, No – 0, Absent 1)

SR Kunsevi - Yes . This motion, made by Director Michelle DePass and seconded by Director Christy Splitt, Passed.

Directors Brim-Edwards: Yes, DePass: Yes, Greene: Yes, Hollands: Yes, Splitt: Yes, Sullivan: Absent, Wang: Yes; Student Representative Kunsevi: Yes (Unofficial)

Subsidiary Motion 1:

Director Brim-Edwards moved and Director Greene seconded the motion to combine Resolutions 7067 and 7068 into one Resolution. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed. (Yes: 6, No: 0, Absent: 1)

Directors Brim-Edwards: Yes, DePass: Yes, Greene: Yes, Hollands: Yes, Splitt: Yes, Sullivan: Absent, Wang: Yes; Student Representative Kunsevi: Yes (Unofficial)

Subsidiary Motion 2:

Director Brim-Edwards moved and Director Greene seconded the motion to amend the combined Resolution 7067 and 7068 to include:

Therefore be it resolved:

1. At the March 18 PPS Board of Education Special Meeting, the Superintendent or her designee will provide a detailed update on each of the high school modernization projects and site specific challenges or opportunities. Time will be available for questions and discussion.

2. At the April 8 PPS Board of Education meeting, the Superintendent or her designee will present the revised draft modernization designs and an update on cost reductions. Time will be available for questions and discussion.

3. No later than April 15 PPS Board of Education meeting, the Superintendent or her designee will present updated designs, projected cost reductions, and a status report on how the designs meet the goals of similar features and elements to the previous high school modernizations and meet the districts education specifications. Staff will also provide the board with an outline of cost reductions or savings in the contracting method. Time will be available for questions and discussion.

4. Regular reports and updates on the cost reduction will be brought to the Board through the end of May.

5. PPS high schools have wide divergences in enrollment numbers. The Board will be provided an outline of a path to enrollment balancing across PPS high schools and a general enrollment strategy to address the reductions in enrollment PPS across the district.

The motion was put to a voice vote and passed. (Yes: 4, No: 2, Absent: 1)

Directors Brim-Edwards: Yes, DePass: No, Greene: Yes, Hollands: Yes, Splitt: Yes, Sullivan: Absent, Wang: No ; Student Representative Kunsevi: Yes (unofficial)

Call to Question:

Director DePass called the question. Director Brim-Edwards appealed the call to question with Director Hollands seconding the appeal. The appeal was put to a voice and resulted in a tie (Yes: 3, No: 3, Absent: 1).

Directors Brim-Edwards: Yes, DePass: No, Greene: Yes, Hollands: Yes, Splitt: No, Sullivan: Absent, Wang: No; Student Representative Kunsevi: Yes (Unofficial)

Resolution to Approve a Senior Chief Salary Schedule (Resolution 7058)

Time: 9:57 pm

A motion to postpone the resolution to a future meeting was approved. Superintendent Armstong commented on why she requested the item be postponed, indicating she would like more time to prepare information to explain how the change in structure would create efficiencies at the central office. Board members provided comments on the proposed salary schedule.

Actions:

Director Eddie Wang moved and Director Christy Splitt seconded the motion to move Resolution 7058 to a future board meeting. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed (Yes: 4, No: 2, Absent: 1)

Brim-Edwards: Yes, DePass: Yes, Greene: No, Hollands: No, Splitt: Yes, Sullivan: Absent, Wang: Yes, Student Representative JJ Kunsevi: Yes (unofficial)

Board Committee and Conference Reports

Postponed to March 18, 2025 meeting

Other Business / Committee Referrals

None

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned by Board Chair Eddie Wang at 10:08 pm.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw
Executive Assistant/Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools

Resolutions As Adopted

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